

SIHYEON KIM

Master's Student in City and Regional Planning
Graduate School of Environmental Studies, Seoul National University
sihyeonkim99@snu.ac.kr · [LinkedIn](#) · [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Urban planning and architecture researcher specializing in Urban Heat Island mitigation, pedestrian thermal comfort, and AI-aided urban climate planning. My research integrates microclimate simulation, geospatial analysis, machine learning, spatial optimization, and cost-effectiveness assessment to identify context-specific heat mitigation strategies. Experienced in leading first-author projects using ENVI-met, SOLWEIG, Python, GIS, and genetic algorithms to support climate-responsive urban planning and design.

EDUCATION

Seoul National University, Graduate School of Environmental Studies	Seoul, Korea
M.S. in City and Regional Planning	2025 – Present
Soongsil University	Seoul, Korea
Bachelor of Architecture (B.Arch), 5-year program	2025
Departmental Honors Award	

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles and Manuscripts

Quan, S. J.*, & Kim, S. (2025). Mixture of Urban Form Archetypes in Seoul: A Signal Processing Approach. (Submission accepted)

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Evaluation of Cost-Effectiveness of Urban Heat Mitigation Strategies in Seoul's Regeneration Projects. Manuscript in preparation.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Budget-Constrained Green-Roof Spatial Optimization in Three Seoul Urban Regeneration Areas: Using SOLWEIG and Genetic Algorithms. Manuscript in preparation.

* Corresponding author

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Seoul National University — Graduate School of Environmental Studies	Seoul, Korea
Advisor: Professor Steven Jige Quan	

Cost-Effective Urban Heat Mitigation across Seoul Urban Regeneration Typologies	Oct 2024 – Present
First-Author Researcher, City Energy Lab	

- Led the full research workflow under the advisor's guidance on research questions and methodology, including statutory urban regeneration plan review, site selection, data collection, and study design.
- Built and cleaned spatial and tabular datasets using Python and GIS; applied PCA and k-means clustering to classify Seoul urban regeneration areas and select representative typologies.
- Developed and validated ENVI-met models to compare green roofs, bright roofs, and permeable pavement using pedestrian-level UTCI across daytime, evening, and full-day periods.
- Integrated installation and maintenance costs with thermal-performance results to evaluate cost-effectiveness and derive typology-specific planning recommendations.

Budget-Constrained Green-Roof Spatial Optimization Using SOLWEIG and Genetic Algorithms	Mar 2026 – Present
First-Author Researcher, City Energy Lab	

- Reframed urban heat mitigation as a fixed-budget spatial allocation problem and led project design, data processing, simulation, optimization, results analysis, and policy interpretation.
- Prepared 2 m raster datasets and conducted unit-level SOLWEIG-GPU simulations for candidate rooftops across three Seoul urban regeneration areas.
- Constructed a precomputed Δ UTCI lookup table and implemented a binary genetic algorithm to maximize pedestrian cooling under six policy budget tiers.

- Evaluated meaningful cooling area, budget-performance curves, marginal returns, and saturation points to distinguish scalable, targeted, and low-sensitivity contexts.

Mixture of Urban Form Archetypes in Seoul: A Signal Processing Approach

2025 – Present

Second Author, City Energy Lab

- Led the qualitative component reviewing Seoul's development history and urban form typologies; synthesized approximately 60 studies across major historical periods.
- Connected SimplexNMF and clustering results with knowledge-based typologies through GIS overlays and a Sankey diagram linking mixture clusters to forms identified in the literature.
- Produced the historical timeline, diagrams, maps, illustrations, and visual materials supporting the qualitative–quantitative interpretation.

UN-Habitat–Collaborative Smart Inclusive Transition Project for Growing and Shrinking Cities

Jul 2025

Research Assistant, International Collaborative Research Project

- Contributed to a UN-Habitat–collaborative project developing the Smart Inclusive Transition Index to compare smartness, inclusiveness, governance, digital innovation, and environmental sustainability across growing and shrinking East Asian cities.
- Collected, standardized, and cleaned multi-source urban data for six growing and shrinking cities in China and conducted Python-based comparative analyses to support city diagnosis and typology development.
- Assisted in translating city-level indicator results into comparative evidence for context-specific inclusive smart-city transition strategies.

Soongsil University — School of Architecture Design, College of Engineering

Seoul, Korea

Advisor: Professor Soomi Kim

Design Method of Incineration Plant Architecture as Healing and Recovery

Mar 2024

First Author; presented at the 2024 Architectural Institute of Korea Spring Conference, Undergraduate Session

- Reviewed adaptive-reuse cases of idle industrial facilities to derive healing- and recovery-oriented regeneration strategies for incinerator architecture.
- Developed a design framework positioning the incinerator as a mediating space where human, machine, and nature interact, and translated the research findings into the Mokdong Incinerator graduation design proposal.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Seoul National University — Graduate School of Environmental Studies

Seoul, Korea

Advisor: Professor Steven Jige Quan

Teaching Assistant, Urban Form and Energy

Spring 2026

- Delivered two hands-on simulation sessions: building energy consumption analysis with DesignBuilder and urban microclimate simulation with ENVI-met.
- Prepared instructional materials and guided students through model setup, simulation workflows, output interpretation, and troubleshooting.
- Managed attendance, assignment checks, and student inquiries throughout the course.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Evaluation of Cost-Effectiveness of Urban Heat Mitigation Strategies in Seoul's Regeneration Projects. 66th ACSP Annual Conference, United States, October 10–12.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Cost-Effective Heat Mitigation across Urban Regeneration Typologies: Implications for Urban Microclimate in Seoul. 20th IACP Conference, Xi'an, China, July 10–12.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Thermal Performance and Cost-Effectiveness of Urban Heat Mitigation Strategies in Seoul's Regeneration Projects. 2nd Workshop on AI for Urban Planning, AAAI-40, Singapore, January 26.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2026). Revealing Hidden Archetypes of Urban Morphological Patterns in Seoul. 2nd Workshop on AI for Urban Planning, AAAI-40, Singapore, January 26.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2025). Assessing Urban Heat Mitigation Strategies in Seoul's Regeneration Projects. 19th IACP Conference, Xiamen, China, July 3–7.

Kim, S., & Quan, S. J.* (2025). Evaluating the Effectiveness of Heat Mitigation Strategies in Seoul's Urban Regeneration Projects. UDIK Spring Conference, Chuncheon, Korea, pp. 792–795.

Kim, S., & Kim, S. M.* (2024). Design Method of Incineration Plant Architecture as Healing and Recovery. Architectural Institute of Korea Spring Conference, Undergraduate Session, March 13.

* Corresponding author

ARCHITECTURAL DESIGN PROJECTS

Soongsil University — School of Architecture, College of Engineering

Seoul, Korea

Individual academic projects; independently completed concept development, site analysis, architectural design, drawings, diagrams, and final visualization.

Healing Fragmentation: Mokdong Incinerator Regeneration

Graduation Project, 2024

Graduation Design Award , Soongsil University

- Reframed an essential but socially isolated waste facility as a mediating public landscape connecting people, nature, and industrial systems; developed a phenomenological healing sequence through changing viewpoints, movement, light, and adaptive reuse.

Urban Play Hub: Yongsan Electronics Market Regeneration

Urban Design Studio, 2023

- Used AI-assisted massing exploration to regenerate a declining electronics district around productive play, healing, logistics, and community programs; reorganized vehicle, pedestrian, and freight circulation at the master-plan scale.

Circulation of Communication: Mobility-Based Yongsan Renewal

Competition Project, 2023

Encouragement Award, Korea Space Design Association National Competition

- Proposed PBV mobility units, modular mixed-use additions, a pedestrian linear plaza, and separated underground logistics to demonstrate future-oriented urban design responsive to changing retail, work, and housing patterns.

Smart Farm + Skin: Eco-Friendly Office

Environmental Design Studio, 2022

Award Winner, Korean Society of Basic Design & Art

- Integrated smart farms, terraces, and a double-skin facade; used IES VE to compare perforation, louver, and window-size alternatives for daylight, natural ventilation, glare control, and reduced lighting-energy demand.

Connecting Multi Paths into Residents' Heart

Housing Studio, 2020

Outstanding Architectural Design Award , Soongsil University

- Designed a stepped artist-housing community in Huam-dong that preserved local topography and urban scale while reconnecting fragmented green space through shared courtyards, private gardens, ateliers, and extended alleys.

Soyo-yu (逍遙遊): Museum Remodeling and Structural Reuse

Adaptive Reuse Studio, 2021

- Preserved the primary core and columns while creating a vertical void, ramps, sunken spaces, and a sequence of metal, wood, and light galleries to reinterpret the work and cultural identity of architect Itami Jun.

HONORS & AWARDS

Academic & Research

- Best Cross-disciplinary Integration Award, Participatory Urban Regeneration Empowered by Artificial Intelligence — 2nd AI4CITIES International Conference & Summer Workshop, Tongji University (2025).

Architecture & Design

- Departmental Honors Award, Soongsil University (2025).
- Graduation Design Award, Soongsil University (2024).
- Encouragement Award, Modular Urban Regeneration Project, Korea Space Design Association National Competition (2023).
- Award Winner, Eco-friendly Office Building Design, Korean Society of Basic Design & Art; Sejong Center Exhibition (2023).

Fine Arts

- Award-winning work exhibited at Korea Art Museum, JoongAng Ilbo Central Painting Competition (2022,2023,2024).
- Award Winner, Korean Society of Basic Design & Art, Oil Painting Division; Sejong Center Exhibition (2023).
- Group Exhibition, 26th Korean Painting Status Exhibition & Korean Women's Painting Competition (2026).
- 1st Prize, AP Art Awards; City Hall Winter Youth Art Exhibition, Tallahassee, Florida (2014–2015).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Design Somnium

Seoul, Korea

Architecture Intern — Multi-purpose Cultural Center Remodeling

Jan 2024 — Jul 2024

- Prepared daily construction reports and documented demolition, structural reinforcement, MEP, façade, and interior work.

- Supported design–construction coordination through CAD and SketchUp modeling and on-site communication.

SKILLS

Programming & Data Analysis: Python (Pandas, NumPy, GeoPandas, Scikit-learn, Matplotlib), statistical analysis, machine learning, genetic algorithms, optimization

GIS & Urban Analytics: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, raster/vector processing, spatial databases, PCA, k-means clustering

Environmental Simulation & Optimization: ENVI-met, SOLWEIG, DesignBuilder, IES VE, micro climate analysis

Design & Visualization: AutoCAD, SketchUp, Rhino 3D, Grasshopper, Ladybug Tools, V-Ray, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Figma

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

Rhino Certification (2025.08) | ESG SNU Youth Forum Certification (2026)

Korean: Native | English: Professional working proficiency

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Sign Language Interpreter Volunteer — Real-time interpretation for church services (2019–Present).
- Volunteer Mentor, Cambodia — Educational program for elementary school students (August 2019).
- International Education: Chiles High School and Deer Lake Middle School, Florida; Meeker Elementary School, Iowa.